Shengli Zhu

Ph.D. Student in Environmental Science and Engineering
King Abdullah University of Science and Technology (KAUST) | Thuwal, Saudi Arabia
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Hydrology and Water Resources; Large-Scale Hydrological Simulation and Prediction; Rainfall-Runoff Modeling; Cold Regions Hydrological Processes.

EDUCATION BACKGROUND

King Abdullah University of Science and Technology **2026 – Present**

Ph.D. in Environmental Science and Engineering | Thuwal, Saudi Arabia

Supervisor: Prof. Hylke Beck

Research Focus: Global hydrological observations and modeling under climate change.

Institute of Geographic Sciences and Natural Resources Research, Chinese Academy of Sciences **2022 – 2025**

M.Sc. in Natural Resource Science | Beijing, China

Supervisor: Prof. Zhaofei Liu

Research Focus: Hydrological process simulation and satellite precipitation evaluation.

Thesis: "*Runoff simulation in the source region of the Yellow River based on satellite precipitation products*".

Shandong Normal University **2018 – 2022**

B.S. in Geographic Science | Jinan, China

Supervisor: Prof. Houfeng Liu

PUBLICATIONS

- ***Zhu, S.***, Wada, Y., Miralles, D.G., Zhang, Y., Miao, C., Bangalath, H.K., Wang, X., Beck, H.E., 2026. Precipitation trend uncertainty from product choice rivals or exceeds the magnitude of actual trends. *Communications Earth & Environment*. DOI: 10.1038/s43247-026-04148-w.
- ***Zhu, S.***, Liu, Z., 2024. Comprehensive quantitative assessment of the performance of fourteen satellite precipitation products over Chinese mainland. *Climate Dynamics*, 62: 6799-6818. DOI: 10.1007/s00382-024-07237-8.
- Yang, H., Yang, F., Sun, L., Ye, Y., ***Zhu, S.***, 2023. Relationship between the North Atlantic sea surface temperature and the summer extreme high temperature in the Beijing-Tianjin-Hebei region, China. *Urban Climate*, 52: 101683. DOI: 10.1016/j.uclim.2023.101683.
- ***Zhu, S.***, Wang, Z., Qu, K., Xu, J., Zhang, J., Yang, H., Wang, W., Sui, X., Wei, M., Liu, H., 2023. Spatial Characteristics and Influence of Topography and Synoptic Systems on PM2.5 in the Eastern Monsoon Region of China. *Aerosol and Air Quality Research*, 23: 220393. DOI: 10.4209/aaqr.220393.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Ph.D. research | Precipitation observations and hydrological modeling | KAUST, Jan 2026–present
  • Evaluate the reliability of long-term global precipitation datasets used for climate monitoring and water management;
  • Quantify how rain-gauge network density affects hydrological simulation and precipitation estimation, to derive performance-based rain-gauge density recommendations.
- M.Sc. research | Hydrological modeling of the source region of the Yellow River (within an NSFC-funded project on alpine river–lake basin hydrology) | IGSNRR, CAS, 2022–2025
  • Set up and calibrated hydrological models for the source region of the Yellow River to simulate runoff processes;

• Investigated how precipitation and snow-related processes affect runoff simulation in this high-mountain basin;

• Evaluated simulated runoff against observed discharge records from hydrological stations in the basin;

• Conducted field hydrological surveys in the basin (2023–2025), installing and maintaining water-level and precipitation monitoring instruments.

SKILLS

- Modeling: HBV, SAC-SMA, TOPMODEL, SPHY;
- Programming: Python, MATLAB, R;
- Software: ArcGIS, QGIS, Git;
- Fieldwork Techniques: Hydrological measurements (e.g., water level and flow velocity) in remote and high-altitude areas, precipitation data collection, use of field instruments (e.g., GPS, Rain Gauge Data Logger, Water Level Data Logger).

ACADEMIC HONORS, FELLOWSHIPS & MEMBERSHIP

- Merit Student of University of Chinese Academy of Sciences 2025
- European Geosciences Union (EGU) Student Membership 2024-Present
- American Geophysical Union (AGU) Student Membership 2024-Present
- The Second prize of the 2023 IGSNRR director's scholarship, CAS 2023